SAINT OF THE WEEK

One of the interesting things that happens in life is making friends with people from different cultures. We learn from other people, especially those different from us. Malachy did that.
This native of Armagh travelled through Europe, and became friends with St Bernard in Clairvaux. When travelling to Rome and back, he always stopped off in Bernard's monastery, and what a chat these two reforming saints must have had. It was in Clairvaux that Malachy fell ill and died, and there with Bernard he was buried.
St Malachy, patron of Armagh, and of friendship, pray for us (feast, Tuesday, 3 November)

(From 'Scandalous Saints and Spirited Sinners', Veritas Publications 2005, by Bernard Cotter)

Point to Ponder:
Faith requires tangible loving actions rather than just passive thoughts.

Finance Corner 25/10/2026

Aughadown: €825
Castlehaven & Myross: €860
Kilmacabea: €875
Skibbereen: €1,520
Rath & the Islands: €666

Thank you for your generosity

CLERGY

Fr. Kevin O'Regan Co-PP (Moderator) PH: 028-22878
Fr Bernard Cotter Co-PP
Ph: 028 60003
Fr Evin O'Brien CC,
PH. 028 22877
****

Alcoholics Anonymous in West Cork: 087 611 4946.
Pieta House Helpline 1800 247247; or text HELP to 51444.
St Vincent de Paul, Skibbereen: 087 918 2698
Samaritans: 116 123 free.
Women against Violence Helpline 1800 203 136

FAMILY OF PARISHES OFFICE

TO BOOK MASSES, ARRANGE WEDDINGS, BAPTISMS, ANNIVERSARIES, ETC.
CONTACT THE FAMILY OF PARISHES' OFFICE, 1 NORTH ST, SKIBBEREEN.
Open Monday, Wednesday, Thursday & Friday: 10 am -1 pm
• Phone 028-22828 • EMAIL stciaranasFOP@gmail.com •
On our website you can find up to date information, request bookings, access newsletters, reflections, livestreams and more!
https://westcorkparishes.ie/



St Ciarán & All Saints
FAMILY OF PARISHES
Newsletter
(for the parishes of Aughadown, Castlehaven & Myross, Kilmacabea, Rath & The Islands, and Skibbereen)

1st November 2026 **All Saints** **Vol. 5:9**

Does Purgatory exist?

Facebook occasionally presents me with an album of photos, tracing my years as a subscriber. It's a limited look back, but always interesting.
When I die, I expect to see a similar review of my life, from God's perspective — an album of memories. Some things I may have conveniently forgotten, and some of the good I did also. When I've made a review with God's loving eyes on me, I can see myself saying I'm not ready to enter heaven — because in that moment of judgement, there can be no lies, only Supreme Truth.
I'll need time to get my head around divine forgiveness, as I remember times I failed to mirror that. I hope my friends will pray for me, to keep my hope alive until I am ready to pass through to eternal Beauty — a destiny promised to all who are faithful.
The Church calls this a time of purification, which is what I've described above. As the Catechism puts it: "All who die in God's grace …. are assured of their eternal salvation, but after death they undergo purification, so as to achieve the holiness necessary to enter the joy of heaven."
What do you think?

Fr Bernard
Email: frbernard1984@gmail.com

The Parishioner

Sunday 01-November-2026



Feast of All Saints

Today we remember all the saints who share the happiness of heaven. We are called to be saints by becoming children of God, by becoming more like our Father. This is our greatest possible fulfilment. It begins already, if we ourselves be moulded by the *Beatitudes.*



The Family of Parishes of: Ballincollig | Ballinora | Kilmurry | Ovens and Farran

Feast of All Saints

We celebrate today the Feast of All Saints, not just the canonized, but all those people who have been faithful witnesses to the love of God by living out the message of the Gospel during their life. We trust that our loved ones, relations and friends are among those who are now enjoying the glory and happiness of being face to face with God. The saints we celebrate were men and women like us. Perhaps we may sometimes think of our departed loved ones as being dead and gone. But our faith helps us to believe that they are alive now more than ever, because they are now fully alive in God. The life they now enjoy can no longer be touched by sickness, suffering, sin, or death. We thank God for all those whom he has already welcomed to heaven. During November we pray especially for those who are still being purified in Purgatory knowing that our prayers can help them. The Second Reading from the First Letter of St John, reminds us of the great love of God who already has chosen to call us His children. "What we are to be in the future has not yet been revealed; all we know is, that when it is revealed, we will be like him, because we will see him as he is."

The Beatitudes in today's Gospel, propose to us a way of life, inviting us to be poor in spirit, that is relying on God to help us through life, to identify with the meek, those who mourn, and those who hunger and thirst after justice. They challenge us to be compassionate people, to be men and women who are pure in heart, and to become peacemakers in our dealings with one another, in our families and in society at large, even when this entails ridicule and persecution. We pray for faith and courage to walk this journey. The saints encourage us in our day-to-day struggles because like us they also endured struggles. Our Faith assures us that all who respond to the Lord's invitation to live the life of the Beatitudes will one day hear those welcoming and consoling words, "Well done, good and faithful servant, enter into the joy of your Lord"

The Beatitudes in today's Gospel are the teachings of Jesus in the Sermon on the Mount Jesus teaches us that if we live according to the Beatitudes, we will live a happy Christian life. The Beatitudes fulfil God's promises made to Abraham and his descendants and describe the rewards that will be ours as loyal followers of Christ.

Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
Blessed are they who mourn, for they will be comforted.
Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the land.
Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be satisfied.
Blessed are the merciful, for they will be shown mercy.
Blessed are the clean in heart, for they will see God.
Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God.
Blessed are they who are persecuted for the sake of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Prayer for Vocations

Loving God, at baptism you have gifted each of us with a call to serve you and all people in everything we do. Give us the strength to share your message of love, justice, hope and peace in every part of our Diocese of Cork and Ross.
We ask you Lord, for the gift of new vocations to priesthood in our Diocese. In your fatherly care, accompany those who are seeking to know your will for them. Inspire those you invite to serve as priests and fill them with the courage to answer that call. Through Christ Our Lord, Amen.



DISCOVERY A faith study as part of the Cork and Ross Diocese faith development

Through Discovery you can deepen your daily life with God and learn a new awareness of just who you are, and how you can live. As the Evangelist John says in 10;10 'have life and have it all in its fullness'. 1 hour per week for 6 weeks. 2 small groups of 6 participants each. Wednesday (Men) Thursdays (Women)

Initial Contact: Fr Alan O'Leary PP or any priest in the family of parishes of Ballinora, Ballincollig, Ovens/Farran & Kilmurry

or

Derval 083 184 74 79 Michael 087 218 52 82

Such Are The Ones Who Seek Your Face, O Lord.

Ballincollig Parish Number for Priest on Duty is: 087 4021357
For Parish office Telephone is 089 4008181 Mon - Wed. 9.00am - 12.30pm

Visit Our Website: theparishioner.ie or Facebook www.facebook.com/ BallincolligParish

Scan for Website

† IN SYMPATHY †

PLEASE PRAY FOR THE FAMILY AND FRIENDS OF THE RECENTLY DECEASED :

Bridie Shanahan, Ennis, Co. Clare.
May Delaney-Madigan, Model Farm Road.
Anne O'Donnell, Donegal.
Roger Duggan, Killarney/Ballincollig.
Michael Magee, Pouladuff.

PLEASE PRAY FOR THE REPOSE OF THE SOULS OF THE FOLLOWING WHOSE ANNIVERSARY OCCURS:

Stephen Hogan, Classes Lake.
Ann O'Connell, Westcliff.
Eileen Nolan, Borris, Co Carlow.
Tim Lyons, Inniscarra.
Liam McNamara, Carrigrohane/Ballincollig.
Noel Hegarty, Maple Lawn.
Mary Desmond, Westcourt.
Patsy Johanna Finn, Glincool.
Neil O'Donoghue (Snr.), Inniscarra View.
Maureen Roche, Inniscarra View.
Liz O' Brien, Ballincollig.

Formation in Faith for Young Adults

The Diocese of Cork and Ross, in collaboration with UCC Chaplaincy and the Presentation Brothers LEAF Project, is delighted to offer a Formation in Faith programme for young adults (18–35 years). The programme began on Wednesday, 30 September 2026, and will run for 9 weeks, from 5.45–8.00pm in Mardyke House, Cork (T12 W8RP). Participants can choose between two concurrent pathways:

a) Sycamore Formation Series: A video-based programme with guided group discussion on Catholic formation.
b) Foundations in Theology: A lecture-based introduction to Catholic theology.
c) Each session begins with food and refreshments, and provide participants with an opportunity to engage in meaningful discussion.

To sign-up or for more information, email Sheila at youthministry@corkandross.org

The Irish Cancer Society

The society is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable (one on one) transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment. If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a significant difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide you with training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most. For more information and to become a volunteer driver, please contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie

Reflection

I pray Lord, for the needy of our world: come among us as one who will help, and call us all to help the hungry and sick, the uneducated and homeless, those who are victims of violence and war, the lonely and depressed. May your coming this Christmas be for them a time of peace and love; may we bring to them, in what way we can the joy of your coming.

READINGS FOR THE WEEK

Thirty First Week In Ordinary Time

01 Sunday Apoc. 7:2-4, 9-14. Ps. 23. 1 In. 3:1-3. Mt. 5:1-12. Lect I: 999 or Lect II: 1244

02 Monday Readings are chosen from Masses for the Dead. Lect III: 849- 890 (or Lect I: 1002)

03 Tuesday Phil 2:5-11. Ps 21.Lk 14:15-24. Lect II: 852

04 Wednesday Phil. 2:12-18. Ps. 26. Lk. 14:25-33. Lect II: 854

05 Thursday Phil. 3:3-8. Ps. 104. Lk. 15: 1-10. Lect II: 856

06 Friday Eccles (Sir). 44:1-15. Ps. 14. Lk. 6:17-23. Lect II: 1367

07 Saturday Phil 4:10-19. Ps 111. Lk 16:9-15. Lect II: 860

Next Sunday's Readings 08-November-2026
Wis. 6:12-16. Ps. 62. 1 Thess. 4:13-18. Mt. 25:1 13. Lect I: 722

Ballincollig Mass Times

St. Mary & St. John		Christ Our Light
8:30 am, 10 am	Sunday	11 am, 12:30 pm
9:30 am & 7:30 pm	Monday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am & 7:30 pm	Tuesday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am & 7:30 pm	Wednesday	8:30 am
9:30 am & 7:30 pm	Thursday	8:30 am
9:30 am & 7:30 pm	Friday	8:30 am
6:00 pm (Vigil)	Saturday	7:30 pm (Vigil)

Ballincollig Bulletin Board

Coeliac Hosts

Low gluten hosts are available and suitable for Coeliac's Please inform the priest prior to Mass if possible if you require it.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament

There will be Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament at 3p.m. until 4p.m. in St. Mary & St. John's Church every Friday.

Meditation

Meditation continues in the Ballincollig Community Hall on Tuesday morning after 9.30am Mass. New members welcome.

Cemetery Masses and The Blessing of The Graves

Mass in St. Oliver's Cemetery Sat. November 7th at 2pm.
Mass in St. Mary & St. John's Cemetery Sat. 31st Oct. at 12 noon.

The November Novena for the Holy Souls

See above table for Mass timings this week for Ballincollig.

Special Remembrance Mass

There will be a Special Mass to remember all our loved ones who died during the past year on Friday November 6th at 7.30pm in St Mary & St John. All those whose funerals took place in the Parish will be remembered at this Mass. Families whose relatives' funerals didn't take place in Ballincollig parish and wish to have deceased family members (who died during the past 12 months) included in this Mass are invited to hand in their names to the Sacristy or Parish Office during the week. Please include a contact name and address. Families and individuals are invited to partake in the Mass.

'A Healing Afternoon Retreat'

Ruah Retreats presents 'A Healing Afternoon Retreat' - Remembering our loved ones, healing our losses, releasing stress and finding hope. Guest musicians, healing ministry & candlelit ceremony, taking place on Sunday, November 22, 2026, from 2:30 p.m. - 6p.m. at Vienna Woods Hotel, Cork. Further information & bookings Via www.ruahrest.com